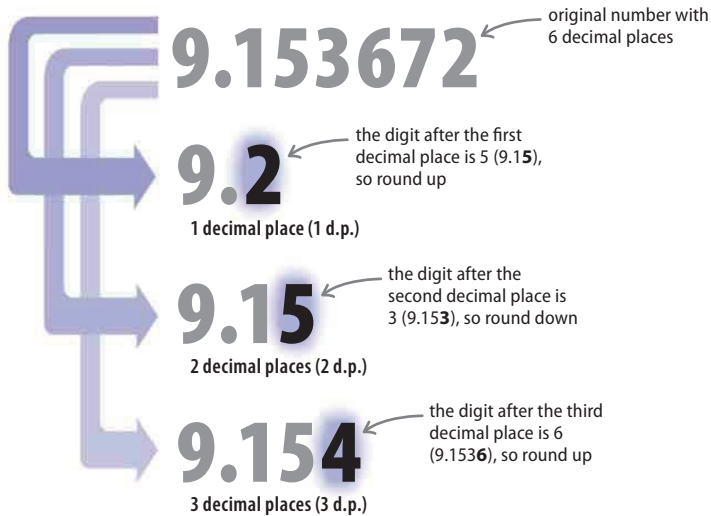


Decimal places

Any number can be rounded to the appropriate number of decimal places. The choice of how many decimal places depends on what the number is used for and how exact an end result is required.



LOOKING CLOSER

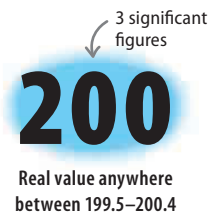
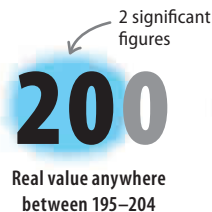
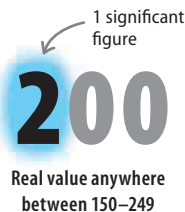
How many decimal places?

The more decimal places, the more accurate the number. This table shows the accuracy that is represented by different numbers of decimal places. For example, a distance in miles to 3 decimal places would be accurate to a thousandth of a mile, which is equal to 5 feet.

Decimal places	Rounded to	Example
1	$\frac{1}{10}$	1.1 mi
2	$\frac{1}{100}$	1.14 mi
3	$\frac{1}{1,000}$	1.135 mi

Significant figures

A significant figure in a number is a digit that counts. The digits 1 to 9 are always significant, but 0 is not. However, 0 becomes significant when it occurs between two significant figures, or if an exact answer is needed.



◀ **Significant zeros**
The answer 200 could be the result of rounding to 1, 2, or 3 significant figures (s.f.). Below each example is the range in which its true value lies.

